

Use-case definition

Describe one candidate use case: what it is, why it matters, which data it needs and what it will change. Fill in one form for each candidate. The answers feed the scorecard (step 2).

Use case
Define 1 · Describe it

Scorecard
Define 2 · Score it

Prioritisation
Define 3 · Choose

BRD or PRD
Define 4 · Require it

TDD
Design · Next stage

How to fill this in

- Write for a busy executive. Use short sentences and business terms. Do not choose technologies here.
- Estimates only need to be right to an order of magnitude.
- If you do not know an answer, write "Unknown" and say who can answer it.

USE-CASE ID

For example UC-SALES-001

TITLE

BUSINESS DOMAIN

The domain the data product is created for

PROPOSED BY

Name and role

DATE

VERSION

0.1

STATUS

☐ Candidate

☐ Scored

☐ Approved

☐ Deferred

☐ Rejected

1 Description

What is it about? Two or three sentences that tell a reader quickly what it is.

2 Justification

Why do it? Refer to the SWOT analysis and list the items this use case addresses: internal strengths (S) and weaknesses (W), external opportunities (O) and threats (T).

S, W, O or T	Item in the SWOT analysis	How this use case addresses it

3 Classification

What is its purpose? Tick all that apply.

- ☐ New product or service
- ☐ Improve operations for example design, development or production
- ☐ Improve intelligence know more about the market, customers, partners, competitors or ourselves
- ☐ Productise data for example aggregated customer data or demographics
- ☐ Enhance company valuation for example data security or brand reputation

4 Business questions

Which questions will it answer, who asks them, and which decisions will the answers support? If the use case is approved, these become the first section of the BRD or PRD.

Question	Who asks it	Decision it supports

5 Data landscape

Which data does it need, and what state is that data in? This section drives the data readiness score.

Existing data

Which data do we already hold? Use the data asset register.

More data

What more data of the same type do we need?

Better data

What data of a different type would suit it better?
For example structured records in place of documents.

Improved data

Is the existing data consistent, with one source of truth? Must it be correct, or is good enough acceptable? Which source is reliable or preferred?

Availability

Can we count on the data staying available?

Velocity

How fast does the data arrive and change?

6 Organisational changes

What will it change? Say what it affects, not how to do it.

Infrastructure

Which company systems does it affect, and how much change do they need?

Data governance

Which data governance rules are new, changed or removed?

Access

Who gains or loses access to which data?

Data culture and skills

Do people need new skills or training?

Organisation structure

Do any teams or roles change?

7 Customer and partner impact**Customer impact**

How will customers be affected: products, services, the way they buy? Will it inconvenience or delight them? Will it bring new customers, or new types of customer?

Partner impact

Suppliers, resellers, call centres and other partners. Do data agreements with other businesses change? Are there new opportunities?

8 Investment

Estimate to an order of magnitude; the implementation plan holds the detail. These answers drive the two investment scores.

Financial investment

☐ Under 10k ☐ 10k to 100k ☐ 100k to 1M ☐ Over 1M

Currency and notes**Time to implement**

☐ Under 1 month ☐ 1 to 3 months ☐ 3 to 6 months
☐ 6 to 12 months ☐ Over 12 months

Notes**9 Benefits**

What will we gain? This complements the justification. Use business terms: profit, cost savings, revenue, company valuation, or indirect gains such as customer satisfaction.

Benefit	Type: profit, cost, revenue, valuation or indirect	How we will measure it	Rough size

10 Risks and dependencies

What could stop or delay it? Does it depend on another use case, team or supplier? Include legal and privacy concerns. This section drives the delivery risk score.

Submission

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Proposed by			
Reviewed by			

Next: Score the use case with the other candidates in the scorecard (step 2).